

6.1.1 Centre and teacher/assessor responsibilities

For the NEA units of this qualification we assume the teacher is the assessor.

Before you plan to get [approval](#) from us to offer this qualification you must be confident your centre can fulfil all the responsibilities described below. Once you're approved, you can offer any of our general qualifications, Cambridge Nationals, Cambridge Advanced Nationals or enrichment qualifications **without** having to seek approval for individual qualifications.

The quality of the delivery of teaching and the integrity of assessments and quality assurance is paramount. Systems must be in place so that assessments are fair, valid, reliable and authentic. One of the key factors behind valid, fair and reliable assessment is the expertise of those doing the assessment and internal quality assurance.

With this in mind, here's a summary of the responsibilities that your centre and teachers must be able to fulfil. It is the responsibility of the head of centre¹ to make sure our requirements are met:

- there are enough trained or qualified people to teach and assess the expected number of students you have in your cohorts and they will complete the **Cambridge Nationals: Essentials for the NEA** online training, prior to assessment of the set assignment. This is available on-demand and accessed through [Teach Cambridge](#) or [Cambridge OCR Train](#)
- teaching staff have the relevant level of subject knowledge and skills to deliver and assess this qualification
- teaching staff will fully cover the knowledge, understanding and skills requirements in teaching and learning activities
- necessary resources are available for teaching staff and students during teaching and assessment activities, to give students every opportunity to meet the requirements of the qualification and reach the highest grade possible
- there's a system of standardisation in place so that all assessment decisions for teacher-marked (centre assessed) assignments are consistent, fair, valid and reliable (see [internal standardisation](#) in section 6.4.3)
- there's enough time for effective teaching and learning, assessment and internal standardisation
- processes are in place to make sure that students' work is individual and confirmed as being authentic (see [Ways to authenticate work](#) in section 6.2.1)
- you must use the OCR-set assignments for students' summative assessments. You must make sure that students use the assignment that is live for the period during which they are taking their summative assessment.
- the OCR-set assignments must not be used for practice (see section 6.2, [Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR-set assignments](#)). This includes both assignments that are currently live or live assignments that have

- expired. Sample assessment material for each of the NEA units is available on Teach Cambridge and the OCR website. The sample assessment material can be used for practice purposes
- students understand what they need to do to get the highest marks possible
 - students understand what it means when we say work must be authentic and individual and they (and you) must follow any requirements we set out to make sure their work is their own
 - students know they must not reference another individual's personal details in any evidence produced for summative assessment in accordance with the Data Protection Act 2018 and the UK General Data Protection Regulations (UK GDPR). It is the student's responsibility to make sure evidence that includes another individual's personal details is anonymised
 - marks submitted to us are correct, accurately recorded and adhere to the published deadlines
 - assessment of set assignments must adhere to the JCQ [Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments \(Vocational and Technical Qualifications\)](#) and JCQ [AI Use in Assessments: Protecting the Integrity of Qualifications](#)
 - a declaration is made at the point you're submitting any work to us for assessment that confirms:
 - all assessment is conducted according to the specified regulations
 - students' work is authentic
 - marks have been transcribed accurately
 - centre records and students' work are kept according to the requirements below:
 - students' work must be kept until after their unit has been awarded and any review of results or appeals processed. We will not consider any review if the work has not been kept
 - internal standardisation and assessment records must be kept securely for a minimum of three years after the date we've issued a certificate for a qualification
 - all cases of suspected malpractice involving teachers or students must be reported (see ['Reporting suspected malpractice'](#) in section 6.3.1).

6.2 Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR-set assignments

The assignments are set by us, taken under supervised conditions, marked by the teacher and moderated by us. Assignments will be available on our secure website, Teach Cambridge.

The set assignments give an approximate time that it will take to complete all tasks. These timings are for guidance only, but should be used by you, the teacher, to give students an indication of how long to spend on each task. You can decide how the time should be allocated between each part or individual task. You are also permitted to spread the tasks across several sessions, and therefore it is permissible for evidence to be produced over several sessions.

We will replace the set assignments each year. New set assignments will be released on 1st June. You **must**:

- only download assignments from our secure website, Teach Cambridge and use the assignments for the assessment series shown on the front cover.
- have made entries for the series you are intending to submit the NEA work for.

- not share the set assignments with anyone from outside of your centre. These must only be shared with appropriate centre staff and students taking the assessments. (More information about maintaining the integrity of assessment materials is in the JCQ document [General Regulations for Approved Centres General and Vocational qualifications](#).)
- make sure students know that they must not share assessment material or their own work with others, including posting or sharing on social media. (More information is in the JCQ guidance [Information for candidates Using social media and examinations/assessments](#).)

Assessment of the set assignments must adhere to the JCQ [Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments \(Vocational and Technical Qualifications\)](#). [Appendix A](#) of this specification gives guidance for creating electronic evidence for the NEA units. Please read Appendix A along with the unit content and marking criteria grids as it might help you plan your delivery of the units.

The rest of this section deals with how we expect you to manage the delivery and marking of the set assignments, so that assessment is valid and reliable. Please note that failing to meet these requirements may be deemed to be malpractice.

Here is a summary of what we need you to do.

You **must**:

- have covered the knowledge, understanding and skills with your students and be sure they are ready for assessment before you start the summative assessment
- use the correct live OCR-set assignment for summative assessment (the dates for which set assignments are live are shown on the front cover). These assignments are only available on **Teach Cambridge**.
- give students the [Student Guidance](#) document before they start the assessment
- make sure students are clear about the tasks they must complete and the criteria they are expected to meet. You can:
 - explain the task
 - provide a copy of the marking criteria to students
- allow students a reasonable amount of time to complete the assignments and be fair and consistent to all students. The time you allow should be in line with the estimated time we think it should take which is stated in the OCR-set assignments. Within that time students can work on the tasks under teacher supervision any time until the date the centre collects the work for centre assessment
- tell the students the resources and sources of assets that they can use in the assignment before undertaking the assessment tasks
- monitor students' progress to make sure work is capable of being assessed against the marking criteria, on track for being completed in good time and is the **student's own** work:
 - NEA work **must** be completed during normal curriculum time and supervised and marked by the teacher/assessor
 - work must be carried out with enough supervision to make sure that the work submitted can be confidently authenticated as the student's own work. You must also be familiar with the requirements of the JCQ document [AI Use in Assessments: Protecting the Integrity of Qualifications](#)

- if you provide any material to prepare students for the set assignment, you must adhere to the rules on using referencing and on acceptable levels of guidance to students set out within the Plagiarism and Feedback sections (see 6.2.2 [Plagiarism](#) and 6.3 [Feedback](#))
- students must produce their work independently (see 6.2.1 and 6.3 on [Ways to authenticate work](#) and [Feedback](#))
- you must make sure students are aware of the requirement to keep their work secure, not share with other students and keep their passwords secure
- allow students to take the initiative to improve any element of their work as they work through the assignment
- use the marking criteria to mark students' work

Before submitting a final mark to us, you can mark students' completed assignment work and allow them to repeat any element of the assignment, reworking their original evidence, provided the assignment is still live for use. We call this a reattempt. Students must have completed the whole assignment before you mark their work. Any feedback given to students on the marked work **must**:

- be factual: telling the student what you have observed, not what to do to improve their work.
- be recorded and available to the moderator (see [section 6.3 Feedback](#)).

You **must not**:

- change any aspect of the OCR-set assignments (scenarios or tasks)
- accept multiple reattempts of work where small changes have been made in response to feedback. Marking and feedback must not be an iterative process
- allow teachers or students to add, amend or remove any work after students have submitted work for moderation. This will constitute malpractice
- give detailed advice and suggestions to individuals or the whole class on how work may be improved to meet the marking criteria
- practise the OCR-set assignment tasks with the students. We provide Sample Assignments for you to use for practice purposes
- create or use practice assignments and practice data which are similar in nature to those set by us
- use past OCR-set assignments, or amend past set assignments, for practice purposes